

Forum types in Moodle

Forums in Moodle courses are great ways to bring interactivity and increased engagement to your Moodle course! A common question asked is, "What forum type is best for the type of discussion I'd like to have?" This handy tip sheet should hopefully answer that question or inspire you to try something new.

Contents

- [A single simple discussion](#)
- [Each person posts one discussion](#)
- [Q and A forum](#)
- [Standard forum displayed in a blog-like format](#)
- [Standard forum for general use](#)

A single simple discussion

A single simple discussion is a single discussion topic which everybody can reply to. Students are not allowed to post their own discussions, they can only reply to the one already given, so you can pose a question for the class and everybody can respond to it. Helpful for keeping discussions on topic.

Display replies in nested form ▾

Example single simple discussion
Wednesday, 12 December 2018, 1:05 PM

What types of things are on the final exam? I bet you already know :)

Let's discuss what you think is on the exam. If you're right, I may just respond with a hint!

[Permalink](#) | [Reply](#)

 **Re: Example single simple discussion**
by [Test Mel](#) - Wednesday, 12 December 2018, 1:07 PM

Guaranteed there's something on the different trophic levels and biomagnification.

[Permalink](#) | [Show parent](#) | [Edit](#) | [Delete](#) | [Reply](#)

Each person posts one discussion

In a forum where each person posts one discussion, forum participants can only post one discussion (but can reply multiple times to discussions). This could be useful in a situation where each student can post on a topic of their own choice and have other students reply to them. This is also useful to limit any one student from posting too many discussions.

Discussion	Started by	Replies	Last post
Unit 2 study tips	 Test Mel	0	Test Mel  Wed, 12 Dec 2018, 12:19 PM
Unit 1 study tips	 Melanie Mattila	0	Melanie Mattila  Wed, 12 Dec 2018, 12:18 PM

Q and A forum

In this forum, the instructor can post a question, and students will reply with an answer. The interesting thing about this forum is that students **cannot see** other replies until 30 minutes has passed and the posts cannot be edited anymore. This could be great for math word problems or scenario-type "What would you do?" type problems, where you may not want students to know what others are saying, in case that has an effect on their own answer.

Display replies in nested form

This is a question and answer forum. In order to see other responses to these questions, you must first post your answer



Word Problem
by Melanie Mattila - Tuesday, 24 January 2017, 12:47 PM

How I see math word problems: If you have 4 pencils and I have 7 apples, how many pancakes will fit on the roof?

Reply

Subject (hidden)
Author (hidden)

This post cannot be viewed by you, probably because you have not posted in the discussion, the maximum editing time hasn't passed yet, the discussion has not started or the discussion has expired.

Standard forum displayed in a blog-like format

You can make a forum look similar in structure to popular blogging sites, such as Blogger. This could be useful for encouraging students to contribute to a class blog.



Zombie ants controlled by fungus

by [Melanie Mattila](#) - Wednesday, 12 December 2018, 11:49 AM

What if I told you that certain types of fungus can exhibit mind control on some ants? It's true!
This is an important part of the life cycle of the fungus - it controls the ant so that it attaches itself to the leaf of a plant at a certain height...just perfect for when it releases spores!

[Permalink](#) | [Edit](#) | [Delete](#)
[Discuss this topic](#) (0 replies so far)



Greenland sharks

by [Melanie Mattila](#) - Wednesday, 12 December 2018, 11:44 AM

These are some of the strangest animals in the whole animal kingdom! Nobody knows for sure how long they live, but estimates suggest they can live up to 300 years! What makes this even more interesting is that they are very slow moving and almost blind, thanks to a type of copepod that feasts on their eyes. How do they catch prey to eat?

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[Discuss this topic](#) (0 replies so far)

Standard forum for general use

This is the default forum type used in Moodle. This particular type of board is great for introductory activities or for class announcements or other news.

Example standard forum

Add a new discussion topic

Discussion	Started by	Replies	Last post
Homework tips	Melanie Mattila	0	Melanie Mattila Wed, 12 Dec 2018, 11:41 AM
Vacation ideas	Melanie Mattila	1	Test Mel Wed, 12 Dec 2018, 11:30 AM

For more information, please contact Moodle Help at moodle@norquest.ca